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Tariff rulings only add to businesses' confusion

No clarity on what will stick, and at what level

By Jim Puzzanghera

GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — Since taking office, President Trump has dramatically increased tariffs, then lowered some, then rolled out more, and then paused others in a dizzying display of trade policy.

Piling onto that confusion, in rulings Wednesday night and again on Thursday, judges in two federal courts declared that many of Trump's tariffs are illegal. One of those rulings was temporarily blocked later Thursday as White House officials pledged to appeal all the way to the Supreme Court.

It amounts to a fresh dose of uncertainty for US business owners already dealing with whiplash as they try to figure out how much they will have to pay for imported foreign goods.

"We've taken a position of remaining cool and seeing what happens," said Dana Katz, owner of Miltons — The Store for Men, a clothing shop with three locations in the Boston area. "And as you can imagine, it's been changing virtually by the day."

He hasn't raised prices yet on his tailored men's suits, blazers, and other merchandise even though about 95 percent of it is imported from a variety of countries. But Katz said he's been in frequent communication with his wholesale suppliers and will have to raise prices if the tariffs remain in place.

Right now, that's a big if.

Trump has made tariffs a centerpiece of his economic policy. He has argued that increasing

TARIFFS, Page A6

Demoulas team denies any plans for a walkout

By Jon Chesto

GLOBE STAFF

One day after Market Basket board members put chief executive Arthur T. Demoulas on paid leave, executives aligned with the longtime supermarket boss pushed back on the assertion that he was planning a potential work stoppage to protect his job.



Arthur T. Demoulas is now on paid leave.

►Some shoppers say they're ready to boycott. **A10.**

"The accusation that the management team . . . is somehow involved in planning a walkout is false," said Joe Schmidt, director of operations for the Tewksbury-based chain. "The assertion that, because the board feels that he has differences with them, would have him want to stage a walkout of some type is preposterous."

The latest drama comes more than a decade after a mass staff walkout at Market Basket that

MARKET BASKET, Page A10

Pride, resolve for Harvard grads

A joyous day takes on a different flavor in the shadow of Trump



PHOTOS BY CRAIG F. WALKER/GLOBE STAFF

The celebration on Thursday capped an academic year marred by attacks on Harvard by the Trump administration.

US judge gives foreign students 'some protection'

By Shelley Murphy

GLOBE STAFF

A federal judge in Boston said Thursday that she would issue an injunction to prevent the government from revoking Harvard University's ability to enroll international students while the school's battle with the Trump administration unfolds.

US District Judge Allison D. Burroughs said an order was necessary because "it gives some protection to international students who might be anxious about coming here or anxious about remaining here once they are here."

She rejected the Justice Department's claim that an order wasn't needed because the government had backpedaled on its vow to immediately take action against Harvard. That backpedaling came in the form of a notification Wednesday night from the Department of Homeland Security (DHS) that Harvard now has 30 days to appeal the government's decision to remove it from the

RULING, Page A7

'You know, he's the greatest person in the world, in his eyes, and Harvard University is the best in the world, so he's got to beat Harvard.'

EVA MOSELEY, *Harvard alum, speaking about President Trump*



President Alan Garber greeted graduates "from down the street, across the country, and around the world."

By Spencer Buell

GLOBE STAFF

CAMBRIDGE — Graduating from Harvard represents a dream fulfilled for many bright, young students around the world. To be here, wedged into folding chairs under the broad oak trees and crimson banners, is to be rewarded for a lifetime of hard work with an unmatched pedigree.

But as graduates and their families massed Thursday in Harvard Yard for the 2025 commencement, a nearly four-century-old tradition, it was clear this commencement would be unlike the 373 that came before it. And that by next year, Harvard might be more unlike itself still.

Before the first diplomas changed hands, the Trump administration launched a scorched-earth campaign against the university, in recent weeks terminating billions of dollars in research grants, threatening to revoke its tax-exempt status, and seeking to bar it from enrolling international students.

Yurong "Luanna" Jiang, a Chinese student who was the ceremony's graduate orator, said in her speech that she was proud to have worked with classmates from 32 countries in her international development program — "real people with laughter, dreams, and the perseverance to survive

COMMENCEMENT, Page A7

Primary care doctors ready to vote on union

MGB's challenge likely to keep matter tied up

By Jonathan Saltzman

GLOBE STAFF

Federal officials in Boston on Friday will count the ballots of roughly 240 primary care doctors deciding whether to form a union at Mass General Brigham. The answer is likely to be yes, but it won't settle the fight over the proposed bargaining unit at the state's largest

health system.

For months, primary care physicians at MGB have said they are overworked, underpaid, and demoralized by the "corporatization of medicine." Last November, many of them filled out cards notifying the National Labor Relations Board that they want to join a union called the Doctors Council.

If they vote yes on Friday afternoon, it would mark the first time that primary care doctors have organized a union chapter in Massachusetts. They would join a wave of doctors unioniz-

ing nationwide, including some in Greater Boston.

But MGB, the corporate parent of Massachusetts General Hospital and Brigham and Women's Hospital, has fiercely opposed the union campaign and shows no sign of retreating.

MGB filed an appeal with the labor board last week challenging the makeup of the prospective bargaining unit, likely putting the matter in limbo indefinitely. That's because President Trump's controversial firing of one NLRB member in January and failure to fill that vacancy

and two others has left the five-member panel without a quorum, paralyzing the watchdog.

"[MGB is] appealing, knowing that cases won't be heard," said Dr. Mark Eisenberg, a primary care doctor at Mass. General and one of the union organizers. "They want to take away our democratic vote. They want to make doctors feel like it's hopeless to fight against a giant."

MGB said in a May 21 memo to employees that its legal challenge "isn't about the outcome of the election — it's about making

DOCTORS, Page A10

From 2000 to 2022, attending physicians filed

44 petitions with the NLRB to form unions in the US, Dr. Kevin Schulman cowrote in JAMA.

There were 33 such petitions in 2023 and 2024.

LETTING IT FLY

Ainsley Cuthbertson of Lexington High School won the discus throw on Thursday at the MIAA Division 1 track and field championships at Tufts University. **C6.**



MATTHEW J. LEE/GLOBE STAFF

Prosecutors wrapped up their case in Karen Read's retrial. **B1.**

Concerts by Shakira and Jason Aldean were abruptly canceled due to a problem with the stage at Fenway Park. **B2.**

Four ex-MBTA employees and a current worker were charged with falsifying Red Line track inspection reports. **B1.**

A new Israeli-backed aid group opened a third hub in the Gaza Strip but

more chaotic scenes unfolded as a desperate population sought food. **A4.**

Some activists are criticizing Governor Maura Healey, saying she's not challenging President Trump enough. **B1.**

Wetting the appetite

Friday: Some sun, then you-know-what. High 74-79. Low 55-60.

Saturday: Rain tapers in the afternoon. High 68-73. Low 52-57. Sunrise: 5:11 Sunset: 8:13

Weather and Comics, G6-7. Obituaries, C9.

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